



What actually went right last week

*The 5 stories readers chose, week of 21
September*

Zoom out: Tuberculosis has killed more people than any other infectious disease in history. Treatment has saved an estimated 83 million lives since 2000. (World Health Organization)



Kenya's Sheldrick Wildlife Trust keeper Misheck spent five months without a day off caring for Wangalla, a week-old elephant calf found hiding among zebras after lions scattered her herd.

What it proves: Misheck's five months of near-constant care show a week-old orphaned elephant can be brought back to a stable, social life in a sanctuary.



Kazakhstan's Kok-Aral Dam increased the northern Aral Sea's water volume 68%, halved its salinity and more than tripled fish production, while Uzbekistan planted 4.2 million acres of the exposed lakebed.

What it proves: A single dam project can partly reverse the shrinking of a major inland sea within a few years.

32%

Burkina Faso's malaria vaccine rollout helped cut recorded cases by 32% and malaria deaths by 44% between 2024 and 2025.

What it proves: Burkina Faso's combined vaccination and prevention program shows a country can nearly halve malaria deaths within two years.

Researchers at NHS Blood and Transplant traced the rare AnWj blood antigen to the MAL gene, solving a mystery open since 1972 and creating a new blood group system.

What it proves: This discovery lets blood banks genetically screen for the extremely rare AnWj negative donors who were previously nearly impossible to identify.

\$250 million

Dave and Cheryl Duffield's foundation committed \$250 million over five years to expand nonprofit veterinary care for pet owners who cannot afford it.

What it proves: Dave and Cheryl Duffield's gift shows a single foundation can fund a five year national fix for the 50 million pet care gap the Foundation identified.

All five stories are linked in the post text above.

“What you do makes a difference, and you have to decide what kind of difference you want to make.”

Jane Goodall

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